

FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 15, 1957.

Graham's Corner

By FRANK GRAHAM

NEW YORK, Nov. 15. — Walker Cooper, leaving the Cardinals after an 18 year stand in the National League as player or coach, goes to Indianapolis as manager, succeeding Andy Cohen. Remember Andy? If you do, you qualify for membership in the late E. V. Durlings' mythical Young Old-Timers' Club. For those who do not remember him, he was a Giant in 1926, 1928 and 1929 and his name always will be linked with that of Rogers Hornsby.

Hornsby, who had won the Cardinals' first pennant and beaten the Yankees in the 1926 World Series, was traded to the Giants the following Winter after a long drawn-out quarrel with Sam Breadon over his contract for the next season, McGraw giving up Frank Frisch and Jimmy Ring, a pitcher, for him. Dramatic as were the circumstances in which he came to New York, equally so were those in which he departed after the 1927 season to Boston in exchange for Frank (Shanty) Hogan, a catcher and Jimmy Welsh, an outfielder.

No explanation was given for the deal, a difficult one to understand, since he still was at his peak. One version, which at least was plausible, was that as acting manager of the club during the latter part of the campaign, he had resented some implied criticism of his tactics by Charles A. Stoneham and responded bitterly. Whatever the reason, he was gone. When John McGraw was asked who would take his place at second base, he said:

"Andy Cohen."

A DIFFICULT SPOT FOR A KID.

This was almost as much of a surprise as the banishment of Hornsby to Boston. Andy was born in Baltimore, but for most of his 24 years had lived in the South or Southwest and in 1926 had come to the Giants direct from the University of Alabama. Used but little that year, he was farmed out to Minneapolis. With that scant experience, he was being asked to succeed Hornsby. Few youngsters entering the major leagues ever have faced such a challenge. None could have faced it with finer courage. He was slow on his feet, but he had a quick mind. He was a steady fielder, had a pretty good arm and could hit. Above all, he was a competitor. But Hornsby was a great player and Andy never was and never would be and the position in which he found himself was untenable.

He broke away to a good start. The fans were with him and he was hitting and, in Boston, Hornsby wasn't. One newspaper carried a daily box comparing their batting records from the opening game, a comparison vastly favorable to Andy. When the Braves came to town for the first time and Hornsby saw the box, he said, with characteristic candor:

"They shouldn't do that. It isn't fair to the boy. I haven't got started yet. When I do, I'll lose him."

And so he did. All things considered, Andy had a pretty good season and hit .274, but Hornsby hit .387. The subject of the trade that had sent Hornsby away from the Polo Grounds, a touchy one with McGraw from the time it was made, became even more so. It was rather generally suspected that it hadn't originated with him, but with Stoneham, and that he had strongly opposed it. But he, too, was a game guy. Never did he fail to praise Cohen and never did he express the slightest regret over the loss of Hornsby.

SOME DAY HE MAY RETURN.

Andy had one more year with the Giants. Injuries kept him out of action for 50 games or so, although, when he was in the lineup, he hit very well and wound up with a mark of .294. But he'd lost some of the eagerness and some of the drive he'd had in 1928 and no one, possibly including himself, was surprised when he did not come back in 1930.

He remained in baseball, however, and as a minor league manager or coach has an over-all good record, taking time out from the game only for service in the Army during the war. Could be that whatever happened to him in Indianapolis, he'll be back in the majors some day as a manager.